

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

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Sexagesima 1914 at St. Anthony's

"Now the Parable is This: The Seed is The Word of God." (Luke VIII 11.)

What beautiful lessons does not Jesus teach us at all times. From the simplest, commonest natural things He brings us at once to the most sublime dogmas of Faith and religion. It is clear from His parables wherever we find them that He beholds things as they really are, as they were intended to be, as they ought to be -- all things pointing and tending to the one prize worthy of every effort, the glory of God, the salvation of souls, the Kingdom of Heaven. The parable today is certainly no exception. On the contrary, it is a most beautiful proof of this His wonderful divine wisdom. More than this: He makes of it a most earnest admonition, a solemn warning. "He that hath ears to hear, let him hear." Will any one ask what the warning may be? Oh dear Christians, these last words contain the warning. The parable itself contains the warning. The warning is manifest in the explanation that Jesus deigns to give. "The seed is the word of God," sown in the hearts of men that they may co-operate with it and bring forth fruit in works of faith. That they may believe in God and live according to Christian Charity - loving God and doing good to men. According as a man receives this divine seed and according to his zeal in cherishing it, so may he be compared or is compared with the wayside, or the rock that has no soil, no moisture, no protection against the devil that "goeth around like a roaring lion" and like birds of prey seeking whom he may devour. In short, the admonition and the warning here sounded is this: Save your souls. Escape eternal hell, "where the worm" (of despair) "dieth not and the fire is not extinguished save your souls. Gain heaven where "neither eye hath seen nor ear hath heard, nor hath it entered into the heart of man to conceive what thing God hath prepared for those that love Him. Amen

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"He that is not with me is against me" Luke XI 15 Dom III
The Son of God came down from Heaven in order to show us the way to Heaven - to peace and happiness. He assumed our human nature becoming one with that we might participate in His divine nature and be one with Him; He makes